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FINANCIAL MANAGER

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This product guide relates to:

Financial Manager

Version 3.5.2

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Glossary



Glossary

Account Code

1. The unique code given to every account, consisting of one to four levels of a maximum twelve characters, as defined by the account's ledger, and used for all fiscal transactions.
2. The term given to the first twelve characters of the account and the last thirty characters of the extension code together.

Account Group

Refers to a line which calls for a range of accounts to be selected from the General Ledger from within a report specification.

Account Hierarchies

You can link accounts within the General Ledger in a hierarchical structure. Postings to accounts at the base of the hierarchy will automatically be posted to accounts within the structure. Accounts higher in the structure summarise postings at lower levels. Any account not at the lowest level in a hierarchy must be a 'memorandum' account.

Account Modifier

An account modifier is used to overwrite characters within the specified General Ledger account codes for a report, in order to limit a general selection for a specific purpose.

Accumulator

Accumulators are used to add together and to print sub-total and total values. There can be up to 999 accumulators in a report. A format which is required to add five values would need five accumulators.

Authorisation

See Report Authorisation and User Authorisation.

Base Currency

When setting up a new company a base currency must be specified. This is the currency into which any non-base currency will be converted for the purposes of

enquiry, reporting and accounting. Once postings have been made to the company the base currency cannot be changed, so it must be decided with care. If an external application such as the Accounts Payable application is linked to a General Ledger, its base currency must be the same as that of the General Ledger.

Budgets

You can hold many different budgets/forecasts for your company's accounts. For example, optimistic, pessimistic and mid-view budgets. Reports and enquiries select budget and forecast records.

Calculated Field/Column

A field within an output format for which the contents are calculated. the most common examples are to add columns together to express the relationship between two columns and to reverse the sign of a value.

Chart of Accounts

The General Ledger set up of ledgers and their accounts which are needed to satisfy the financial and management accounting requirements of your company.

Column

The arrangement on an output field of value (numeric) fields across the report. Calculations can be carried out on column data. See also **Field** and **Work Column/Work field**.

Company Modifier

An option which allows you to print data from another company based on the range specifications you set up for the company in which you are working.

Company Profile

The General Ledger is a multiple company application and a number of parameters for each of its companies must be set up before the application can be run. The Company Profile contains all the basic rules within which a particular company is to operate.

Compressed Print

The facility to print characters using different font sizes and pitches - usually expressed in *cpi* (characters per inch). Usual values are 10, 12 or 14 cpi.

Control Account

A control account holds values posted from all the accounts of a sub-ledger beneath it. It cannot be posted to directly.

Currency Code

In General Ledger you can define a default currency to a company as its base currency. If you are running General Ledger in a multi-currency environment, a transaction may be entered in any currency defined to the system. The currency code refers to the currency to be used, and provides default exchange rates, etc.

Data Dictionary

A set of fields from which you can select and print General Ledger data. The data includes:

- Application-defined account fields such as value posted in a period.
- Application-defined constants such as company name, period number, date.
- User-defined fields for use in reports.

Default

A default value is a value stored by the system for use when no other value can be found. For example, when setting up extension codes for an account, you have the option to specify default codes which will appear in the extension code window whenever the account is entered.

Detail Format

The part of the body of the report which holds the bulk of the data. It prints the detail lines on a report.

Exchange Rate

The number of units of one currency which may be bought or sold for one unit (or, in many cases, 100 units) of another currency.

Exchange Rate Code

The code set up to define the exchange rate between two currencies.

Field Type

Fields can be of three types within this application:

- Data dictionary
- Accumulator
- Calculated

A field can also have a literal value, where the text is entered directly into the format.

Fiscal Accounts

General Ledger accounts used to calculate the worth of profit and loss of your company. (See also Memorandum Accounts).

Flag

A trigger to activate or deactivate certain facilities and parameters within the application.

Forecasts

You can hold many different budgets/forecasts for your company's accounts. For example, optimistic, pessimistic and mid-view budgets. Reports and enquiries select budget and forecast records.

Format

See Output Format.

General Ledger

The principal book of company accounts for statutory and management financial reporting - often called Nominal Ledger in the UK.

Generated Source

The RPG programs generated from the user-defined report specifications, which go to print the report.

Heading Format

The part of the report which forms its title headings, such as descriptions of columns, and sundry details such as company, date, etc.

Ledger

A ledger is a collection of accounting records made up by double-entry bookkeeping. It is divided into ledger accounts each of which records transactions of a particular type.

The structure of a ledger defines the structure of all of its accounts.

The two top ledgers are the Balance Sheet and the Profit & Loss ledger. Beneath these are sub-ledgers which feed values into control accounts above them.

Ledger Levels

Each ledger is made up of levels, which define the structure of the ledger's accounts. A ledger may have up to four account levels and five extension levels.

There are several types of level: Global levels - extension levels which are reserved across all levels within a company

X-ledger levels - levels which cross two or more ledgers in a company's Chart of Accounts

Ledger levels - levels which are defined for a single ledger

Level Codes

Each account is made up of level codes depending on how the account's ledger is defined. An account may have a maximum of four account level codes of up to nine characters each, and a maximum of five extension level codes of up to fifteen characters each.

There are several types of level codes:

- Global level codes
- X-ledger level codes
- Sub-ledger level codes - codes which are defined for accounts within a single ledger
- Account level codes - codes which are defined for a single specified account's extension levels. (Not to be confused with the general term for account codes).

See also **Report Level Codes**.

Literal

The text you enter within an output format to appear on the report.

Memorandum Accounts

General Ledger accounts which are not used to calculate the worth or profit and loss of the business. (See also **Fiscal Accounts**).

Modifier

A means of adapting a specification to differing requirements.

Multi-currency

Trading in several currencies, linked to a single currency or multi-currency General Ledger.

Multi-company

A General Ledger structure which is designed to control more than one independent company or several companies reporting to a controlling or reporting company.

Operation

The arithmetic process performed in the creation of a user-defined data dictionary field or output format. The operations available are: add, subtract, multiply, divide, percentage.

Output Formats

Output formats define the way in which information is presented on reports, including the way in which value fields are printed in columns. They do not define the vertical presentation of reports.

Owner

The user who is currently enabled to control access to the report specification. This is the author of the report, initially, though you can change ownership.

Parameter

A characteristic or constant factor defined by you or already in the system, which determines the specific form or specific limitations of a function.

Period

The units into which a financial year is divided for accounting purposes (usually 12 or 13). These are the same for each financial application linked to the General Ledger.

Prime Currency

The prime or *transaction* currency is the currency in which a transaction is made, as opposed to the **Base Currency**, into which transaction values will be converted.

Prompt

A facility which brings up a list of records relating to a data entry field. To activate, enter a ? and then press **F4=Prompt**.

Rate Code

See Exchange Rate Code

Report Authorisation

The authorisation given to users to maintain and/or run a report.

Report Groups

A list of reports which are linked together so that they can be run together as a single selection.

Report Specification

A set of instructions which the Financial Manager can interpret to produce user-defined printed reports. The set of instructions consists of:

- The report description
- The output format used in sequence
- Forms definition and other parameters

Roll Keys

Keys used for the purpose of viewing the next 'page' of details.

Also **Roll Up** and **Roll Down**.

Total Format

The part of the report which forms the totals beneath each column.

Transaction

A general term used to describe a unit of financial data submitted to the application - such as an invoice.

Transaction Currency

See Prime Currency

Trial Balance

A report which prints the net value posted to each top level account (excluding memorandum accounts) for a selected period and year-to-date. It also confirms that the ledger is in balance.

User

The owner of a report or someone else authorised to modify and/or run a report.

User-defined View

A defined number of account levels arranged in any order you want and used for enquiry, report and budgeting purposes.

Utilities

A set of procedures for verification, utilisation and management of the application database. They are not required during normal operation, and when used may require technical support.

View

See User-defined View.

Work Formats

Work formats are used to summarise accounts. They are defined as containing zero lines. Their main purpose is to add into accumulators which are used in subsequent formats for printing.

X-ledger Level

A ledger level which spans two or more ledgers in a company's Chart of Accounts.

X-ledger Level Codes

Account codes set up within X-ledger levels so that they can span two or more ledgers in a company's ledger structure.

Year Modifier

Used in a user-defined data dictionary field to change the year to which a period value relates. For example, period '12' with a year modifier of '1-' refers to period '12' of last year.

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